

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

You'd better take a deep breath!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Are you a nervous person? How do you react in stressful situations?
- Is it hard for you to change your mind about important things? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about customer service.
- I can offer advice and solutions.
- I can persuade someone to change his or her mind.





Let's Explore!

Sarah tries some of Vanessa's tips and **tricks***. Will it work?

* A "trick" is a suggestion to help make your work more effective.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Customer:** Excuse me, I have a few questions about the set lunch.
Sarah: Certainly, sir. Today, our appetizer is a Waldorf salad and our main course is a slow-cooked beef shank with mashed potatoes and seasonal vegetables.
Customer: That sounds promising ... The only problem is that I am a vegetarian.
Sarah: Oh, I'm sorry to hear that, sir. In that case, would you like to have a look at our menu? We have a wide assortment of à la carte items for our vegetarian guests.
Customer: Can't I change my main for something else? I'd rather still pay the set price!
Sarah: I'm awfully sorry, sir. We do not offer substitutions for lunch.
Customer: That's not what I wanted to hear! Is there any way that you could check with the chef?
Sarah: I'm afraid the chef is very particular about his creations. He's very proud of his work, and a little susceptible to bad moods, if you see what I mean.
Customer: I see ... I wouldn't want to make him angry! He's the one wielding the knife after all.



Let's Practice!

Sarah practices her customer service skills

Instructions: Read the sentences carefully. There are two possible options. Circle the correct word or expression. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. Excuse me, I have a few questions about the meet lunch / set lunch.
2. Certainly, Sir. Today, our appetizer / womanizer is a Waldorf salad.
3. We have a wide assortment of a la carte items for our vegetarian guests / bests.
4. Can't I change my main / make for something else?
5. We do not offer substitutions / distributions for lunch.
6. I'm afraid the check / chef is very particular about his creations.



Let's Practice!

You should try the beef shank instead!

Instructions: Underline the correct answer. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. What is a suggestion or recommendation?
 - a. I am awfully sorry, the chef does not offer dinner substitutions.
 - b. Would you like to have a look at the menu?
 - c. You ought to try our slow-cooked seasonal vegetables.
 - d. I wouldn't want to make the chef angry.





Extension Activity

Go the extra mile for good customer service!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find information about customer service practices in 5 countries of your choice.
- Is good customer service important? Is the customer always right?
- How do staff and managers deal with difficult customers? Do happy customers leave a big tip after their meal?
- Write 2 or 3 sentences for each country.
- Share your information with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research information about customer service.

☐ ☐

I write a report on service practices in different countries.

☐ ☐

I read my report aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **set lunch** (noun): a combination of courses chosen by the chef for a fixed price
e.g. Our set lunch has a vegetarian option.
- **Waldorf salad** (noun): a salad with apple, walnut and celery
Example: Our Waldorf salad is excellent.
- **slow-cooked** (adjective): cooked at low temperature for several hours
e.g. You should try our slow-cooked beef shank.
- **guest** (noun): a patron; customer
Example: We have a wide assortment of vegetarian options for our vegetarian guests.
- **substitution** (noun): change
Example: I'm sorry, but we do not offer menu substitutions for lunch.
- **particular** (adjective): careful about details
Example: Our chef is very particular about his creations.
- **susceptible** (adjective): likely to change to another state or feeling
e.g. Our chef is susceptible to bad moods.
- **to wield** (verb): to use a weapon or tool
e.g. Vanessa wields the knife like a professional.





Learning Points

Being Persuasive

When you work in a restaurant or a shop, it is important to be persuasive to be able to change a customer's mind about something.

Remember to be polite and use appropriate expressions to persuade someone.

You use expressions like *Don't you think ... ?* , *Don't you agree ... ?* or *... if you see what I mean* to convince or persuade someone to change their minds.

You use *should*, *ought to* or *would rather* to suggest what is necessary.

Example: *Don't you agree that we should leave soon?*

Here, "Don't you agree" politely persuades someone to leave. The use of "should" suggests that leaving is necessary.

Examples:

• **Ann:** *Can't the chef change my menu?*

Waiter: *I'm awfully sorry, but the chef is very proud of his work, **if you see what I mean.***

Offering Advice and Solutions

When you work in a restaurant or in a shop, it is important to offer advice and solutions properly.

Remember to offer advice politely and to use the modals *could*, *should* or *might* to propose a solution.

Here is a list of expressions you can use to offer advice and solutions:

- You might want to ...
- Would you mind ... ?
- You should ...
- You ought to ...

Examples:

• **Ann:** *I'm vegetarian. Do you have anything without meat?*

• **Bob:** *Our set lunch doesn't have anything vegetarian. You might want to try some a la carte items.*

